

RICKY J. SPARKS

TECHNOLOGY PROFESSIONAL

Software, Data & Technical Support

Menlo Park, CA | 909-645-9512 | rickyjames1750@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/rickyjsparks | github.com/rickyjames1750 | Portfolio: rickyjames1750.github.io

SUMMARY

Technology professional with B.S. and M.S. degrees in Computer Science and experience in technical support, data operations, and SQL/Python development. Skilled in application troubleshooting, data quality, customer communication, documentation, and software development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Development & tools: Python, SQL, Git, Unix/Linux, Tableau, software development
Support & quality: Application troubleshooting, issue reproduction, escalation, QA/QC, data validation
Data & delivery: Data pipelines, metadata, requirements clarification, process documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Master Chings Auto Inc. | San Jose, CA

Data Engineer | Sep 2025 - Oct 2026

- Developed SQL and Python transformations and data pipelines to prepare datasets for analysis and reporting.
- Implemented checks for nulls, duplicates, and unexpected values; documented processing steps and used Git for version control.
- Collaborated with stakeholders to clarify requirements, resolve data inconsistencies, and define repeatable workflows.

Data Operations Associate | Sep 2024 - Aug 2025

- Verified and reconciled records, maintained structured metadata, and flagged discrepancies before data entered downstream workflows.
- Documented QA/QC and verification procedures to support consistent data preparation and repeatable internal processes.

Forward Health | Bay Area, CA

Technical Support Engineer | Jun 2022 - Aug 2024

- Diagnosed application and workflow issues, reproduced problems, and documented resolution or escalation steps.
- Communicated with customers to gather context and set expectations; escalated complex cases to engineering and product with structured reproduction steps.
- Provided application guidance and maintained notes on recurring issues and resolutions.

Course Hero | Redwood City, CA

Metadata Specialist, Contract | Jan 2020 - Apr 2020

- Verified Textbook Solution content against source documents before publication; maintained metadata standards and documented repeatable QA workflows.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Walkify | **Co-Founder** | Aug 2023 - May 2024
Led a team of three through product requirements and launch planning for an immersive Apple Vision Pro concept; communicated product vision across technical and business stakeholders.

EDUCATION

California State University, Chico | M.S. Computer Science | May 2026
California State University, East Bay | B.S. Computer Science | May 2024
B.S. GPA: 3.74/4.00 | Summa cum laude | Dean's List